



• THE RACK REPORT • BY DATACENTRE254

What is actually live, in one briefing.

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Data centres. Power. Cloud. Connectivity. Investment. Policy.

The week's most important developments, written for the people building, financing and regulating Kenya's digital infrastructure. This week: the verified board, the 230 MW question, and the licence deadline. Every fact in this briefing carries its source and date.

Kenya's infrastructure story is growing quickly. The numbers only make sense when you separate them.

Kenya's digital infrastructure story is growing quickly, but the numbers become misleading when **announcements, construction projects and operational infrastructure** are treated as the same thing. They are three different kinds of fact. An announcement is intention. A construction site is capital at risk. An operational facility is serving load.

This week, DC254 looked at what can actually be verified, and re-checked every figure against the directory before publishing this issue. The result is a simple discipline: **count what is live, list what is announced, and never let the two blur** into one flattering number.

Sources: DC254 directory and cable tracker, Q3 2026 snapshot, re-verified 5 October 2026

The verified board, on one screen

27

facilities and projects tracked in Kenya (31 including the first East Africa reference records)

20

operational, from the coast to the capital and its satellite towns

10.5 MW

verified live IT load, published by 8 of the 20 operational facilities

230 MW

announced pipeline: 77 under construction, 53 committed, 100 early stage

7

submarine cable systems currently in service at Mombasa

The 230 MW pipeline is not 230 MW of operational capacity.

That is this newsletter's central lesson. The pipeline splits into 77 MW physically under construction, 53 MW committed, and 100 MW resting on a single early-stage announcement. The 10.5 MW is a floor, not a ceiling: most operational facilities do not publish a live load figure, so Kenya's real running load is higher and unmeasured in public data. Read the two numbers side by side, never added together.

The value is not knowing a project exists. It is knowing where it sits.

Every DC254 record carries a status, and the four statuses mean very different things: **Operational, Under Construction, Committed, Early Stage**. The ladder matters because certainty decays at every rung. The 20 operational facilities carry 42.9 MW of designed capacity. The 3 under-construction projects, iXAfrica NBOX1.2 (18 MW), Africa Data Centres NBO2 (15 MW) and Nxtra by Airtel at Tatu City (44 MW), have capital committed and structures going up. The 1 committed project, iXAfrica NBOX2 at Tilisi (53 MW), has a developer on the hook. The 3 early-stage records, led by the Microsoft and G42 announcement (100 MW stated), are intentions.

OPERATIONAL	UNDER CONSTRUCTION	COMMITTED	EARLY STAGE
20 42.9 MW designed; 10.5 MW published live	3 77 MW: NBOX1.2, NBO2, Nxtra Tatu City	1 53 MW: iXAfrica NBOX2, Tilisi	3 100 MW stated (Microsoft-G42); 2 unquantified

One geographic fact sharpens the picture: every non-operational record sits in the Nairobi metro, while Mombasa's four records are all operational. The next 230 MW, if it gets built, lands where the demand, fibre and staff already are.

Read the full briefing → data-centers-254.vercel.app/articles/kenya-digital-infrastructure-what-is-live

Sources: DC254 directory, Q3 2026, re-verified 5 October 2026; operator disclosures

Kenya's international connectivity story begins at Mombasa

DC254 currently tracks **10 submarine cable systems, with 7 in service**: TEAMS and SEACOM (2009), EASSy (2010), LION2 (2012), DARE1 (2021), PEACE (2022) and 2Africa (2024). The other 3 sit at different stages of development, and the distinction matters as much here as it does on land.

TEAMS · 2009	SEACOM · 2009	EASSy · 2010	LION2 · 2012	DARE1 · 2021	PEACE · 2022
2Africa · 2024					
Africa-1 · landed, RFS pending	Daraja · announced	LuLu · planned			

7 IN SERVICE · 3 IN DEVELOPMENT, TRACKED

Africa-1 has landed at Mombasa but has not announced ready for service, so it is not counted as live. **Announced, landed, ready for service and operational are not interchangeable terms**. A single RFS announcement changes Kenya's live cable count for the first time since 2024, which is why the tracker watches the coast as closely as the rack row.

Explore the map → data-centers-254.vercel.app/infrastructure/map

Sources: DC254 cable tracker, verified monthly; operator and consortium disclosures

The licence question that outlasts the deadline

Kenya's proposed **standalone data-centre licence** is this week's other important development. The Communications Authority's consultation is still open, with the consultation period closing **on or about 8 October**, thirty days from the 8 September publication.

The interesting question is not merely the proposed licence. It is the treatment of **existing NFP and ASP licence holders**, who can currently keep operating data centres without taking the new one. The same point surfaced in this week's LinkedIn discussion on the framework. The question to watch: **will the final framework create materially different regulatory positions between existing NFP/ASP licence holders and new data-centre entrants?** Surfacing the issue is the job; pretending we already know the answer is not. Submissions close soon, and whoever files will be reading that carve-out closely.

Sources: Communications Authority of Kenya, consultation published 8 September 2026, page re-verified 5 October 2026

Three things likely to matter next

WATCH 01

Data-centre licensing.

How the CA resolves the proposed standalone framework, and what it does with the NFP/ASP carve-out.

WATCH 02

Capacity vs pipeline.

Whether announced projects progress into construction and ultimately into operational capacity. The 230 MW is the number to watch move, rung by rung.

WATCH 03

Mombasa connectivity.

Movement among the cable systems currently tracked as landed, RFS-pending or planned. One RFS call changes the live count.

Keep the categories separate

The infrastructure behind the headline matters. A project announcement tells us something. Construction tells us more. An operational facility tells us much more. DC254's job is to keep those categories separate. We don't count an announcement as infrastructure.

Access digital intelligence →

Explore the latest DC254 research, directory and infrastructure maps at data-centers-254.vercel.app/research.

EDITOR'S NOTE

Verification standard. Every figure in The Rack Report carries its source and publication date, and we do not publish numbers we cannot trace to an operator, regulator or dated news report. Where plans are announced but not yet contracted, we say so in the same breath as the headline figure, because the difference between a plan and a project is where infrastructure stories go to hide. This issue's figures were re-verified against the DC254 dataset on 5 October 2026.

Corrections and tips. Spotted something wrong or know something we should verify? DC254 corrects errors openly and quickly. Reach the newsroom through the contact page at data-centers-254.vercel.app, or reply to any edition of this briefing by email.

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